



Gaming consoles have always been pictured as one of the many ways by which a family can spend some time together. Multiplayer gaming has always been encouraged by consoles for quite a long time. Each player could have their own controller unlike the PC which required two players to use the same keyboard. However, times have changed, console gaming has changed from being a simple affair between family and friends to one which is fueled by energy drinks, a bevy of colourful vitriolic lingo and an intense hatred for one the other player's mother. We're kidding.

Console gaming slowly started to change, from being dedicated platforms for development studios to work on, they have now evolved to be quite similar to the PC with the adoption of the x86 architecture. Now developers can develop once and and easily port it onto the different console platforms with minimal investment. While on the path to convergence, consoles have seemingly lost their unique charm and with PC form factor growing smaller by the day, their very existence is threatened.

Over the decades since the very first console was made by Ralph Baer, there have been many devices which have worn the console tag. In fact, there have been more than 70 consoles since the early '70s. And from among these, each device that attained mainstream popularity has brought something new to the gaming ecosystem. The latest in this line being the widespread adoption of VR. In this FastTrack, we'll be exploring how the different generations of consoles distinguished each other from the previous ones. What innovations they brought with themselves and how they gave impetus to an entire new industry – gaming. An industry which now boasts of a \$91 billion in annual revenue.

We'll take a look at the different form factors that gaming consoles have popularised, some which have become synonymous with gaming